

Problem

Find the phase angle between

$$i_1 = -4 \sin(377t + 55^\circ) \quad \text{and} \quad i_2 = 5 \cos(377t - 65^\circ)$$

Does i_1 lead or lag i_2 ?

Step-by-step solution

Step 1 of 1

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Consider the signals $i_1 = -4 \sin(377t + 55^\circ)$ and $i_2 = 5 \cos(377t - 65^\circ)$.

Express the signal i_1 in standard form of a sinusoid.

$$\begin{aligned} i_1 &= -4 \sin(377t + 55^\circ) \\ &= 4 \sin(377t + 55^\circ + 180^\circ) \quad [\text{since, } \sin(\omega t + 180^\circ) = -\sin(\omega t)] \\ i_1 &= 4 \sin(377t + 235^\circ) \quad \dots\dots (1) \end{aligned}$$

Therefore, the alternate form of i_1 is $4 \sin(377t + 235^\circ)$.

Similarly express the signal i_2 in standard form of a sinusoid.

$$\begin{aligned} i_2 &= 5 \cos(377t - 65^\circ) \\ &= 5 \sin(377t + 90^\circ - 65^\circ) \quad [\text{since, } \sin(\omega t + 90^\circ) = \cos(\omega t)] \\ i_2 &= 5 \sin(377t + 25^\circ) \quad \dots\dots (2) \end{aligned}$$

Therefore, the alternate form of i_2 is $5 \sin(377t + 25^\circ)$.

Compare the equations (1) and (2) to find the phase difference.

$$\begin{aligned} \phi &= 235^\circ - 25^\circ \\ &= 210^\circ \end{aligned}$$

Hence the phase difference is 210° and i_1 leads i_2 .